Adding and Subtracting Fractions

Name _____ **Date** _____ No calculator **Version 1**

KEY WORDS common denominator · equivalent fraction · mixed number · improper fraction · negative · simplest form

A Different denominators ●○○ — ANSWER ON THE SHEET

Remember: Find a number both denominators go into, change both fractions to it, then add or subtract the tops. Simplify at the end.

1. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} =$ _____ **b)** $\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{6} =$ _____ **c)** $\frac{2}{3} - \frac{1}{4} =$ _____ **d)** $\frac{5}{6} + \frac{3}{8} =$ _____

e) $\frac{7}{10} - \frac{2}{5} =$ _____ **f)** $\frac{3}{8} + \frac{5}{12} =$ _____ **g)** $\frac{4}{5} - \frac{2}{3} =$ _____ **h)** $\frac{5}{9} + \frac{1}{6} =$ _____

B Mixed numbers ●●○ — WORK IN YOUR BOOK

Remember: Change each mixed number to an improper fraction first. Write the answer back as a mixed number.

2. Work out. Give each answer as a mixed number or a fraction in its simplest form.

a) $1\frac{1}{2} + 2\frac{1}{3}$ **b)** $2\frac{3}{4} + 1\frac{5}{6}$ **c)** $3\frac{1}{4} - 1\frac{3}{4}$

d) $4\frac{1}{6} - 2\frac{2}{3}$ **e)** $2\frac{2}{5} + 1\frac{7}{10}$ **f)** $5\frac{1}{8} - 2\frac{1}{2}$

g) $1\frac{5}{6} + 3\frac{3}{4}$ **h)** $6\frac{1}{3} - 2\frac{5}{6}$ **i)** $3\frac{3}{8} + 1\frac{5}{12}$

C Negative fractions ●●○ — WORK IN YOUR BOOK

Remember: Treat the signs as you would with whole numbers: $-\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{4}$ is $-\frac{2}{4}$, because $-3 + 1 = -2$. The denominator never changes sign.

3. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $-\frac{1}{2} + \frac{3}{4}$ **b)** $\frac{2}{5} - \frac{4}{5}$ **c)** $-\frac{2}{3} - \frac{1}{6}$

d) $-\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{2}$ **e)** $\frac{1}{3} - \frac{5}{6}$ **f)** $-\frac{5}{8} + \frac{3}{4}$

g) $-\frac{1}{4} - \frac{2}{3}$ **h)** $\frac{7}{10} - \frac{4}{5}$ **i)** $-\frac{3}{5} + \frac{1}{4}$

© 2026 Cell Tuition. You may print and photocopy this worksheet for your own classes and children. It may not be changed, sold or posted on other websites.

D Negative mixed numbers ●●● WORK IN YOUR BOOK

⚠ **Watch out:** A negative mixed number is all negative: $-2\frac{1}{3}$ means $-\frac{7}{3}$, not $-2+\frac{1}{3}$.

4. Work out. Give each answer as a mixed number or a fraction in its simplest form.

a) $-1\frac{1}{2}+2\frac{3}{4}$ **b)** $2\frac{1}{3}-3\frac{1}{2}$ **c)** $-2\frac{1}{4}-1\frac{1}{2}$

d) $1\frac{1}{5}-2\frac{1}{2}$ **e)** $-3\frac{2}{3}+1\frac{5}{6}$ **f)** $-1\frac{3}{8}-2\frac{1}{4}$

E Problems ●●● WORK IN YOUR BOOK

5. At dawn the temperature was $-1\frac{1}{2}$ °C. By noon it had risen by $2\frac{3}{4}$ °C. What was the temperature at noon?

6. A baker has $2\frac{1}{4}$ kg of flour, uses $1\frac{2}{3}$ kg, then buys another $1\frac{1}{2}$ kg. How much flour is there now?

7. A share price fell by $1\frac{3}{8}$ dollars on Monday and rose by $\frac{3}{4}$ of a dollar on Tuesday. What was the change over the two days?

8. A plank is $3\frac{1}{5}$ m long. Pieces of $1\frac{3}{4}$ m and $\frac{3}{4}$ m are cut off. How long is the piece that is left?

★ Extension FOR EARLY FINISHERS

9. Work out $-\frac{1}{2}+\frac{3}{4}-\frac{5}{6}$.

10. What must be added to $-2\frac{1}{3}$ to make $\frac{1}{2}$?

11. Two fractions add to $\frac{1}{6}$. One of them is $-\frac{3}{4}$. What is the other?

© 2026 Cell Tuition. You may print and photocopy this worksheet for your own classes and children. It may not be changed, sold or posted on other websites.

Adding and Subtracting Fractions

Name _____ **Date** _____ No calculator **Version 2**

KEY WORDS common denominator · equivalent fraction · mixed number · improper fraction · negative · simplest form

A Different denominators ●○○ — ANSWER ON THE SHEET

Remember: Find a number both denominators go into, change both fractions to it, then add or subtract the tops. Simplify at the end.

1. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{5} =$ _____ **b)** $\frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{4} =$ _____ **c)** $\frac{3}{4} - \frac{2}{5} =$ _____ **d)** $\frac{5}{6} + \frac{1}{4} =$ _____

e) $\frac{9}{10} - \frac{3}{5} =$ _____ **f)** $\frac{5}{8} + \frac{1}{12} =$ _____ **g)** $\frac{4}{5} - \frac{1}{3} =$ _____ **h)** $\frac{7}{9} + \frac{1}{6} =$ _____

B Mixed numbers ●●○ — WORK IN YOUR BOOK

Remember: Change each mixed number to an improper fraction first. Write the answer back as a mixed number.

2. Work out. Give each answer as a mixed number or a fraction in its simplest form.

a) $1\frac{1}{3} + 2\frac{1}{2}$ **b)** $2\frac{1}{4} + 1\frac{5}{6}$ **c)** $3\frac{1}{5} - 1\frac{3}{5}$

d) $4\frac{1}{8} - 2\frac{3}{4}$ **e)** $2\frac{3}{5} + 1\frac{9}{10}$ **f)** $5\frac{1}{6} - 2\frac{1}{2}$

g) $1\frac{7}{8} + 3\frac{1}{4}$ **h)** $6\frac{1}{4} - 2\frac{5}{6}$ **i)** $3\frac{5}{8} + 1\frac{7}{12}$

C Negative fractions ●●○ — WORK IN YOUR BOOK

Remember: Treat the signs as you would with whole numbers: $-\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{4}$ is $-\frac{2}{4}$, because $-3 + 1 = -2$. The denominator never changes sign.

3. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $-\frac{1}{2} + \frac{2}{3}$ **b)** $\frac{3}{7} - \frac{5}{7}$ **c)** $-\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{8}$

d) $-\frac{2}{5} + \frac{3}{10}$ **e)** $\frac{1}{4} - \frac{5}{6}$ **f)** $-\frac{7}{8} + \frac{1}{2}$

g) $-\frac{1}{3} - \frac{3}{4}$ **h)** $\frac{9}{10} - \frac{3}{5}$ **i)** $-\frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{5}$

© 2026 Cell Tuition. You may print and photocopy this worksheet for your own classes and children. It may not be changed, sold or posted on other websites.

D Negative mixed numbers ●●● WORK IN YOUR BOOK

⚠ **Watch out:** A negative mixed number is all negative: $-2\frac{1}{3}$ means $-\frac{7}{3}$, not $-2+\frac{1}{3}$.

4. Work out. Give each answer as a mixed number or a fraction in its simplest form.

a) $-1\frac{1}{3}+2\frac{1}{2}$ **b)** $2\frac{1}{4}-3\frac{1}{2}$ **c)** $-2\frac{1}{5}-1\frac{1}{2}$

d) $1\frac{1}{6}-2\frac{2}{3}$ **e)** $-3\frac{3}{4}+1\frac{5}{8}$ **f)** $-1\frac{5}{8}-2\frac{1}{2}$

E Problems ●●● WORK IN YOUR BOOK

5. At dawn the temperature was $-2\frac{1}{4}$ °C. By noon it had risen by $3\frac{1}{2}$ °C. What was the temperature at noon?

6. A baker has $3\frac{1}{2}$ kg of flour, uses $1\frac{3}{4}$ kg, then buys another $1\frac{1}{3}$ kg. How much flour is there now?

7. A share price fell by $2\frac{1}{4}$ dollars on Monday and rose by $\frac{5}{8}$ of a dollar on Tuesday. What was the change over the two days?

8. A plank is $4\frac{1}{3}$ m long. Pieces of $1\frac{5}{6}$ m and $\frac{2}{3}$ m are cut off. How long is the piece that is left?

★ Extension FOR EARLY FINISHERS

9. Work out $-\frac{2}{3}+\frac{3}{4}-\frac{1}{6}$.

10. What must be added to $-1\frac{1}{4}$ to make $\frac{2}{3}$?

11. Two fractions add to $\frac{1}{4}$. One of them is $-\frac{2}{3}$. What is the other?

© 2026 Cell Tuition. You may print and photocopy this worksheet for your own classes and children. It may not be changed, sold or posted on other websites.